

Gerlich Brings Court-Side Lessons to the Classroom

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Texas Tech women's head basketball coach addresses TTU MBA students on leadership, trust, and building a winning culture.

When Head Coach Krista Gerlich stepped into the Jerry S. Rawls College of Business Administration Building last weekend, it wasn't to scout recruits or review film. It was to connect with future business leaders, bringing the message that leadership in both business and athletics starts with relationships.

Gerlich, who enters her 7th season as the Lady Raiders Head Coach, was the featured speaker at the TTU Rawls College of Business 5th Annual MBA Day, where she spoke candidly with current and former Rawls MBA students, sharing the principles that have shaped her leadership style and helped revive the Lady Raider basketball program.

Following a successful season and return to the NCAA Tournament, Coach Gerlich shared a familiar theme to any coach or business leader who has built something from the ground up: culture is not a byproduct of winning; it is the foundation that makes success possible. Gerlich shared how her journey from Lady Raider Team Member to Head Coach has shaped her coaching philosophy, which includes building strong relationships with her players and staff. Constructing an environment of trust, accountability, and shared purpose has been as important to the Lady Raiders' success as any recruiting class or game plan.

For the MBA students in the room, many making their next career move or navigating their own leadership challenges, the parallels were hard to miss.

Gerlich's appearance at MBA Day reflected another important anecdote from her talk: Texas Tech University is built on relationships in which students, alumni, and staff can rely on beyond the TTU campus. It's a growing recognition that at Texas Tech, the lessons learned on the court are just as valuable as the ones learned in the boardroom, front offices, and organizations of every kind, driving home the connection all Texas Tech Red Raiders share.